Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Critique, test and redirect the design

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why do professional studio makers test a new paint mix or foil texture on a small scrap swatch before putting it straight onto their main piece?

Correct: Testing on a swatch proves the fix works without risking damage to hours of work on the main panel — Exactly. A two-minute swatch test gives you 100% confidence before touching the main piece.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Which of these peer critique comments gives the maker a clear, actionable target? -> Your central truss is crisp; try adding chrome dry-brush to the lower cross-bars so they stand out from the black base (Yes! It names a specific strength and a clear technical fix.)

Q2: What should you do if a glued card beam on your panel has curled slightly at one end? -> Slide a thin dab of PVA under the lifted corner with a card sliver and press under a flat weight for two minutes (Correct. Fixing structural adhesion

now ensures a crisp final piece.)

Q3: Where do you mount your 6 cm test swatch at the end of the lesson? -> On your Week 4 studio log critique sheet right next to your 'Before -> Fix -> After' note (Spot on. The physical swatch plus your note is top-grade studio evidence.)

Exit check answer

Question: Why do we keep and mount our small test swatch in our studio log?

Correct: It provides visual evidence of how we tested and solved a design problem before altering the main piece — Correct. Swatches prove thoughtful, deliberate refinement.